

STEADY PRESS

Chronic Pain & Symptom Journal

Ninety days of structured tracking for pain, symptoms, sleep, mood and treatment — built to be handed to a specialist.

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FORMAT	PAGES	USE
US Letter	16	Print as many copies as you need

How to use this journal

- ☐ Complete the daily log every evening
- ☐ Log flares the moment they start, not afterwards
- ☐ Update the body map every two weeks
- ☐ Shade the 90-day grid daily
- ☐ Weekly review each Sunday, monthly review at month end
- ☐ Take the summary page to every appointment

THE SCALE YOU WILL USE

NO PAIN

1 Noticeable, easy to ignore 3 Annoying, does not stop you 5 Hard to concentrate through 7 Limits what you can do

9 Unable to function

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

My history in one page

Write this once. It saves repeating your story at every new appointment.

SYMPTOMS BEGAN

DIAGNOSED?

DIAGNOSIS

HOW IT STARTED

WHAT HAS BEEN TRIED SO FAR

WHEN	TREATMENT / PROFESSIONAL	OUTCOME

TESTS AND RESULTS

DATE	TEST	RESULT

Where it hurts

DATE _____

A simple line drawing of a human figure from the front. A vertical dashed line runs down the center of the body. A horizontal dashed line crosses the vertical line at the level of the chest. This horizontal line is labeled 'Heart and Lungs' in the center. The vertical line is labeled 'Trachea' at the top, just below the neck area.

A Aching / dull **S** Sharp / stabbing **B** Burning **T** Tingling / numb **R** Radiating (draw an arrow) **St** Stiff / restricted

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Daily log

Print ninety of these, or one per day as you go.

DATE	SLEEP (HRS)	SLEEP QUALITY /10	ENERGY /10	MOOD /10

WORST PAIN TODAY

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
NONE										WORST

AVERAGE PAIN TODAY

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
NONE										WORST

SYMPTOMS

SYMPTOM	0-10	WHEN	NOTE

TODAY I MANAGED

☐ Got out of the house	☐ Worked a full day	☐ Exercised or stretched
☐ Ate properly	☐ Saw someone	☐ Slept through
☐ Took meds as planned	☐ Did my exercises	☐ Rested deliberately

ANYTHING ELSE

Flare log

A flare is worth more data than a normal day. Fill this in while it is happening.

DATE	STARTED AT	ENDED	PEAK (0-10)

WHAT I WAS DOING BEFOREHAND

HOW IT FELT AND WHERE

WHAT I DID ABOUT IT

TIME	ACTION TAKEN	EFFECT

IN HINDSIGHT, THE LIKELY CAUSE

90-day grid

START DATE

END DATE

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45
46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60
61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75
76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90

— 0–2 · good day / 3–4 · manageable x 5–6 · difficult # 7–10 · flare • Treatment changed

Trigger tracker

LOGGED TRIGGERS

DATE	SUSPECTED TRIGGER	DELAY BEFORE PAIN	SEVERITY	CONFIDENT?

CONFIRMED TRIGGERS SO FAR

MEDICATION	DOSE	TIMES PER DAY	STARTED	PRESCRIBED BY

Appointments & therapies

LOG

DATE	PROFESSIONAL	WHAT WAS DONE	ADVICE GIVEN	COST

NEXT STEPS AGREED

EVERY SUNDAY

Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	AVG PAIN	SLEEP	NOTABLE

WHAT MADE IT BETTER

WHAT MADE IT WORSE

ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

Monthly review

The only page where you are allowed to zoom out and judge whether anything is actually working.

MONTH

GOOD DAYS

BAD DAYS

AVERAGE PAIN THIS MONTH

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

NONE

WORST

BETTER THAN LAST MONTH

WORSE THAN LAST MONTH

TREATMENTS TO KEEP

TREATMENTS TO STOP OR QUESTION

WHAT I WILL RAISE AT MY NEXT APPOINTMENT

APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

DATE OF VISIT

SEEING

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

QUESTION

YOUR ANSWER

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

☐ Rest

☐ Heat

☐ Ice

☐ Stretching

☐ Painkillers

☐ Physio

☐ Massage

☐ New pillow

☐ Desk changes

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

Summary sheet

Copy the highlights here and hand this single page over. Nobody reads ninety pages.

NAME

PERIOD COVERED

DATE

THE NUMBERS

MEASURE

VALUE

MAIN SYMPTOMS, IN ORDER OF IMPACT

CONFIRMED TRIGGERS

WHAT HAS HELPED

WHAT HAS NOT

Before you start

These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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